The Kiwi Identity: More Than Just Rugby and Hobbits

Target Audience: B1+ / B2
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach
Lesson Objectives:

- Educational (Content): Understand the core values that define New Zealanders (Kiwis): resourcefulness (ingenuity), connection to nature, and "mateship."
- Linguistic (Language): Practice vocabulary related to identity and values (e.g., *resourceful, down-to-earth, ingenuity, mateship, hospitality*), and develop viewing and problem-solving skills.
- Socio-cultural: Develop cultural understanding by analyzing what makes a "national character" and applying Kiwi values to a real-life crisis, comparing it with the students' home culture (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and introduce the concept of "national character."	5 min	Teacher shows a picture of a Kiwi bird and a rugby ball. Ask: *"What do you think of when you hear 'New Zealand'?"* Write ideas on the board. Then ask: *"Are these things stereotypes or reality?"*	Pictures of Kiwi bird, rugby, and Hobbiton.
Controlled Practice	Pre-teach vocabulary needed for the video.	7 min	Students match words: *resourceful, down-to-earth, ingenuity, mateship, hospitality*. Look at the title *"The Kiwi Identity"*. What values do you think are important to New Zealanders?	Vocabulary Match, presentation slide
Viewing	Develop viewing skills for specific information	10 min	Students watch the video *"New Zealand's Values (Ngā Mātāpono)"*. They complete	Our Countr...

	(values).		a table, noting down the values mentioned and how they are expressed.	
Post-Viewing	Develop critical thinking and cultural understanding.	8 min	Teacher explains the concept of *"Number 8 Wire mentality"* (using whatever is at hand to fix a problem). Ask: *"How does this relate to the value of 'ingenuity'? Why is this important for a small, isolated country?"*	Board, a picture of a wire.
Freer Practice	Apply knowledge, develop speaking and problem-solving skills through the "Dialogue of Cultures"	15 min	Crisis Management Role-Play. Group work. Students are locals in a small NZ town hit by a storm (no power, flooded roads, 50 tourists stuck). They must decide on 3 immediate actions using Kiwi values. Dialogue of Cultures. Discuss: *"Why do you think New Zealanders are famous for this 'can-do' attitude? How would people in your country react in a similar crisis?"*	Crisis template, board
Homework and feedback	Summarize and reflect.	5 min	*Do you think a national identity is something you are born with, or something you learn?"* Homework: Write a short paragraph (50 words): *"What value do you think is the most important for people in your country? Why?"*	Notebooks

Match the words (1-5) with their definitions (A-E).

Word	**Letter**	**Definition**

1. Resourceful	[ ]	A. Good at finding ways to solve problems, especially using what is available.
2. Down-to-earth	[ ]	B. The quality of being friendly, generous, and welcoming to guests.
3. Ingenuity	[ ]	C. Practical, sensible, and not pretentious (not trying to seem more important than you are).
4. Mateship	[ ]	D. The ability to be clever, original, and inventive.
5. Hospitality	[ ]	E. Loyalty and friendship, especially between people who share difficult experiences.

Vocabulary Match

1. A
2. C
3. D
4. E
5. B

Watch the video *"Our Country's Values"* and complete the table below.

Note: The video lists several core values (Ngā Mātāpono). Listen carefully to find at least three of them.

Value mentioned in the video (English or Maori)	**What does it mean in practice? (Explain in your own words)**
1. _____	_____ _____
2. _____	_____ _____

3. _____ _____

Question: Which value do you think is the most unique to New Zealand? Why?

Answers:

1. Manaakitanga (Care for people)

2. Kaitiakitanga (Guardianship of the environment)

3. Whanaungatanga (Kinship/Connection)

4. Ingenuity (Number 8 wire)

The "Number 8 Wire" Mentality

What is it?
"Number 8 wire" refers to a standard gauge of steel wire historically used by New Zealand farmers to build fences. Because New Zealand is a small, isolated country far from the rest of the world, farmers could not easily buy new parts or call repairmen when something broke. Instead, they used Number 8 wire to fix everything—from gates to tractors.

What does it mean today?
Today, the "Number 8 Wire Mentality" is a famous New Zealand cultural concept. It symbolizes Kiwi ingenuity, resourcefulness, and a "can-do" attitude. It means being practical, solving problems creatively with whatever you have on hand, and not giving up when things get difficult.

Why is it important for New Zealand?
Because New Zealand is geographically isolated, its people had to learn to be independent and self-reliant. This mentality helped the country survive and thrive. Today, it is a source of national pride and is often used to describe the innovative spirit of New Zealanders (Kiwis).

Situation: You are a group of locals in a small New Zealand town (population: 5,000). A massive storm has just hit. The main road is flooded, the power is out, and 50 tourists are stuck in the town. The emergency services cannot reach you for 48 hours.

Your Task: As a group, decide on 3 immediate actions you will take, using the Kiwi values from the video:

- *Ingenuity (Number 8 wire mentality)*
- *Care for people (Hospitality)*
- *Connection to place (Using local resources)*

Action 1: _____
(Which Kiwi value does this use?) _____

Action 2: _____
(Which Kiwi value does this use?) _____

Action 3: _____
(Which Kiwi value does this use?) _____

Discussion Question: Why do you think New Zealanders are famous for this "can-do" attitude? Is it because they live on isolated islands?